

news feed

DIGIT FEBRUARY 2002

hypothesis

HomeStation

■ What is it?

HomeStation is a multifunction consumer appliance rumoured to be from Microsoft. It is believed to be based on the Xbox design. Microsoft is yet to confirm this.

■ What does it offer?

This home device is said to handle almost everything that a typical PC user needs. It will have features such as e-mail and Web browsing capabilities. HomeStation boasts of digital video recording, DVD capability, etc.

■ When will it see the light of day?

Rumour has it that HomeStation will hit the market by the middle of 2002.

snapshot

483 million wireless devices will be sold in 2003
One-third of the world's population will own a wireless device by **2008**

Source: www.cyberatlas.com

iMacs go flat



Apple recently unveiled their latest flat-panel equipped iMac desktops. The PowerMacs had already made the move to LCD displays earlier in 2001. From Apple's perspective this marks the death of the CRT display.

The new iMac will be offered in 700 MHz and 800 MHz PowerPC G4 processor based versions. All the new variants

have 32 MB nVidia GeForce2 MX graphics cards, five USB ports and a couple of FireWire ports. The drives on these are either a DVD-recorder, a combo CD-RW/DVD-player, or a regular CD-RW drive. The top end version is really impressive, with an 800 MHz G4 processor, 256 MB of RAM, a 60 GB hard drive and a DVD-recording drive.

Looks like innovation still lives at Apple.

Blush and you're caught!

Man is the only creature that blushes, or needs to, said Mark Twain. If blushing can be taken as an index of lying, then liars are in trouble indeed.

Researchers at Mayo clinic in Minnesota in the US have developed a high-definition thermal imaging camera which scans the face of the person who's being interrogated.

It has been proved that when people lie, blood tends to rush to the eye area. This movement is caught by the camera and often proves decisive in nabbing criminals at check-in counters at airports, in courtrooms, and so on.



ILLUSTRATIONS: Mahesh Benkar

The test results are pretty impressive—up to 75 per cent of the guilty people were caught red-handed. This camera is much more faster and easier to use than other methods like Polygraph tests which are used nowadays. How will the liars (and criminals) avoid this one?

Distributed computing fights anthrax

Does your PC have spare processing power? If so, donate some of it for an anthrax cure.

That's what Intel and Microsoft's new distributed computing initiative is all about. It will help British researchers analyse 3.5 billion molecules for a cure to protect anthrax patients from late-stage toxins. Antibiotics have no effect against these toxins.

Distributed computing uses a worldwide volunteer network of computers to do work that would otherwise require supercomputers. The user downloads a program, which allots unused processing power for data crunching. Results are then sent to the project sponsor.

■ Intel names Paul Otellini as president & COO ■ Experts predict mass-mailing viruses in 2002 ■ KaZaA suspends downloads pending Dutch court ruling